



Serie A

Inter Milan kept its 14-game unbeaten streak (13 wins, one draw) alive as it defeated relegation-battling Lecce 2-0, thanks to late goals from Manuel Akanji and Henrikh Mkhitaryan.

It opened up a 10-point gap between league leader Inter (64) and city rival AC Milan, whose 24-game unbeaten run came to an end after a narrow 0-1 loss against Parma.

Reigning champion Napoli sits third after giving up a one-goal lead to lose 1-2 to Atalanta. It is level on points with Roma, which beat

Cremonese 3-0, with all goals coming in the second half.

Meanwhile, record winner Juventus is winless in three games after losing 0-2 to Como and sits fifth with 46 points from 26 games, four behind Napoli and Roma.

Bundesliga

Harry Kane (**above**) was once again at the forefront as Bayern Munich honoured the English striker for reaching the milestone of 500 career goals — achieved with his brace against Werder Bremen in matchday 22. He followed that up with another

double in Bayern's hard-fought 3-2 victory over Eintracht Frankfurt.

RB Leipzig and Borussia Dortmund played out an entertaining 2-2 draw, while Bayer Leverkusen was edged out 0-1 by Union Berlin.

Hoffenheim shared the spoils in a 2-2 draw with Koln, and VfB Stuttgart was held 3-3 by Heidenheim in another high-scoring encounter.

After matchday 23, Bayern leads the standings with 60 points, ahead of Dortmund (52), Hoffenheim (46) and Stuttgart (43). Leipzig, on 41 points, sits fifth.

Ligue 1

The top spot in Ligue 1 has been a topsy-turvy affair between Paris Saint-Germain and RC Lens and, after two-thirds of the season, it is the Parisian side that holds a two-point advantage.

Luis Enrique's side eased past last-placed Metz with Desire Doue, Bradley Barcola and Goncalo Ramos all finding the net. PSG's bid to retain its title was given a significant boost after Lens surrendered a two-goal lead before losing 2-3 to AS Monaco.

Odsonne Edouard and Florian Thauvin seemed to have handed Lens all three points, but Folarin Balogun got Monaco back in the game before Denis Zakaria and Ansu Fati (**below, centre**) scored in a span of two minutes to turn the tie. The result left Lens second with 52 points from 23 games.

UEFA Champions League

When Real Madrid and Benfica were pitted against each other in the UEFA Champions League 2025-26 playoff round, fireworks were expected given the drama of their previous encounter in the league phase.

Instead, an alleged racist incident took centre stage. It began in the 50th minute after Vinicius scored the only goal of the game and broke into a dance in front of the opposition fans, much to the annoyance of the Benfica players.

While he was booked for his excessive celebrations, things turned controversial when Benfica's Prestianni covered his mouth with his shirt before allegedly directing a

